THE LIVING WORLD

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THE MONTHLY EDITION / OCTOBER 2026

Environmental defenders testify about attacks in Latin America linked to Canadian mining companies

The Inter-American Commission on Human Rights heard testimony Oct. 27 from representatives of six countries alleging harm linked to Canadian mining companies' operations, including four alleged attacks on environmental defenders.

THE EDITION

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A considered selection of source-linked reports from 01 November 2026. Stories retain their original reporting context and source details.

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A NOTE FROM THE EDITORS

This digital edition is composed as a traditional book: one page at a time, with a quiet reading rhythm, printed page numbers and source notes. The production technology stays behind the pages.

Environmental defenders testify about attacks in Latin America linked to Canadian mining companies

31 OCT 2026

The Inter-American Commission on Human Rights heard testimony Oct. 27 from representatives of six countries alleging harm linked to Canadian mining companies' operations, including four alleged attacks on environmental defenders. The regional agency gathered in Panama to examine Canada's obligations with respect to its extractive companies and their impact overseas on human rights and the environment. Canada is home to about half of the world's publicly listed mining and mineral exploration companies with operations both in Canada and abroad. The latest revelations add to long-standing concerns about the conduct of Canadian mining companies overseas. Marco Manobanda, an Indigenous fish-farmer from Las Naves, Ecuador, testified that the El Domo copper and gold mine, owned by two Vancouver-based companies, Silvercorp Metals Inc. and Salazar Resources Ltd., is causing deforestation and water contamination where he lives, impacting the ecosystem and his livelihood. "If this mining continues, they're going to keep polluting our water, and we'll run out of resources. And since we make our living from that land and its resources, where are we supposed to go?" Manobanda said. The hearing comes about four months after the government eliminated the Canadian Ombudsperson for Responsible Enterprise (CORE), which was created to investigate complaints about human rights abuses and environmental harm linked to Canadian companies in the garment, mining and oil and gas sectors operating outside of Canada. In the wake of this decision, advocates say they have been left with limited options to seek meaningful redress. The Inter-American Commission on Human Rights is an...This article was originally published on Mongabay

Young Canadians focus on mental health at key climate trial

31 OCT 2026

At a landmark Canadian trial focused on the government's obligations to fight climate change, the young plaintiffs suing Ottawa over alleged policy failures have sought to focus attention on their mental health.

How citizen scientists are mapping Pune's trees, with hopes of a greener future

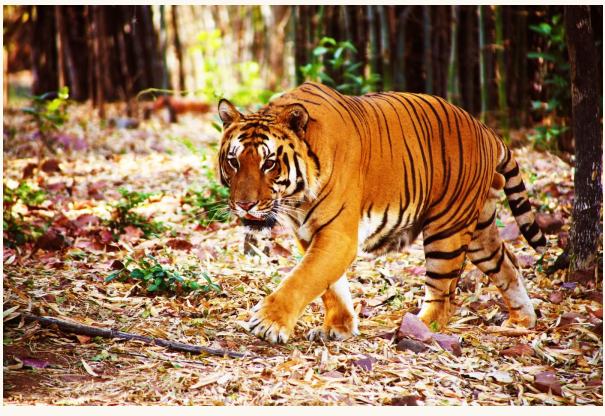


An Indian pitta photographed in Bankura, West Bengal. Representative Indian bird photograph; it is not claimed to depict a specific bird assessed by the national Red List project. / Arup Ruidas · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:INDIAN_PITTA.jpg

30 OCT 2026

PUNE, India - On a quiet Saturday morning, away from the usual urban rush of Pune, citizens gather at the Madhavrao Scindia Garden along the banks of the Mula River. Out on the water, two fishers quietly navigate their boat surrounding a dense forested area on the other side of the river; the cooling shade and chirping birds feel like a natural alarm that you would want to listen to every day. Such a setting is increasingly rare in a bustling metropolis like Pune, where the population is estimated at 7.9 million, yet these volunteers arrive every weekend equipped with measuring tapes, smartphones and a keen curiosity to explore and document the trees in the city's riparian zones. On this particular Saturday, a group of seven visits a city park along a riverbank, where trees stand tall against the sky. The volunteers belong to Pune River Revival, a grassroots movement formed in response to the Pune Riverfront Development Project, a large urban redevelopment plan along the Mula-Mutha rivers aimed at creating promenades, recreational spaces and infrastructure along the riverbanks. The total estimated cost of the project is around 4,727 crore rupees (about $500 million). "We started organizing the tree mapping exercise systematically in 2024," explains Raghunandan Patil, a volunteer with the group. "While our volunteers used to do tree mapping earlier manually, at that time, the group was not well-versed in the technical details of how to map a tree properly and create thorough documentation." Patil adds that now they...This article was originally published on Mongabay

After Botswana, Nepal tries artificial scent marking to fend big cats off villages



A tiger photographed in India. Context photograph for the wider conservation-recovery discussion; it is not the tiger shown in the linked report. Context photograph; not a photograph supplied by the l / Ayush Baheti · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tiger,_India.jpg

30 OCT 2026

KATHMANDU - In March 2025, a tiger followed a forest trail through Nepal's Khata Corridor until it reached a small iron stake next to the path. Attached to it was a dispenser releasing a laboratory-made version of a chemical found in the scent markings big cats use to mark their territory and communicate with other cats. A camera trap recorded the Bengal tiger (Panthera tigris tigris) approaching the station. The curious cat investigated the smell and then stopped, one of multiple instances of tigers and leopards coming up to these scent stations and then turning back the way they came. These encounters offer an early glimpse into an international experiment seeking to harness big cats' territorial instinct in order to keep them away from livestock, farms and human settlements. But researchers caution that a tiger turning away from an experimental station is not yet solid evidence that the method can prevent livestock attacks. "It's a long way from proving that - and we don't claim otherwise," said Martin Gilbert, a wildlife veterinarian, epidemiologist and associate professor at Cornell University in the U.S. who helped bring the research to Nepal. "At this stage, we're asking a more fundamental question: Can these compounds reliably alter a predator's behavior?" A woman with her goats in the buffer area in Bardiya. Image by Tulsi Rauniyar for Mongabay. Across Nepal's buffer-zone settlements, encounters with tigers, leopards and snow leopards have led communities to use electric fences, flashing lights and other

After Botswana, Nepal tries artificial scent marking to fend big cats off villages

deterrents to protect livestock and...This article was originally published on Mongabay

Angola designates Serra do Pingano as a protected area amid rapid forest loss



River and forest landscape in Nameri National Park, Assam, India. Context landscape photograph; not an image from the global conservation-area research dataset. / Debuapriyo · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Landscape_of_Nameri_National_Park.jpg

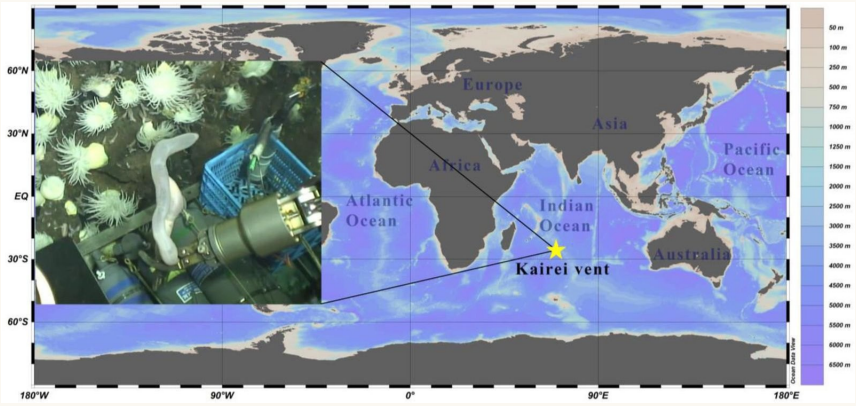
30 OCT 2026

The last large tracts of forest in Serra do Pingano, in northern Angola, are disappearing rapidly, leaving the landscape increasingly bare. Over the past two decades, central Serra do Pingano lost 43% of its original forest cover, while the wider Serra do Pingano Forest Ecosystem (SPFE) lost 21%, equivalent to 536 square kilometers (207 square miles) of forest. The findings appeared in Nature Ecology & Evolution earlier this year. Two of the paper's authors are Angolan. Signed by 11 researchers from multiple institutions, the study serves both as an urgent warning and as a call to action to protect what remains of the vanishing forest. After years of appeals, the Angolan government established the Serra do Pingano Conservation Area in April. Located in Uíge province, the SPFE encompasses several densely forested mountain ranges of high biological value. Pingano forms an ecological transition zone between tropical rainforest and miombo savanna, bringing together elements of western Central African forests and species and evolutionary lineages associated with southern and eastern Africa. It also shelters some of Angola's last remaining tropical forest south of the Congo River. The Nature Ecology & Evolution study brings together evidence from years of research into the SPFE. One of its co-authors spoke with Mongabay. Thea Lautenschläger, a German ethnobotanist specializing in northern Angola and scientific director of the Botanical Garden of Hamburg, described the threats facing the forest and the species that depend on it. "It is difficult to say to

Angola designates Serra do Pingano as a protected area amid rapid forest loss

what extent our work directly influenced the...This article was originally published on Mongabay

Scientists discover mysterious seahorse lookalikes that no one has ever seen alive



A deep-sea sea cucumber photographed at the Kairei hydrothermal-vent field in the Indian Ocean. Context photograph from the Indian Ocean; not a photograph from the Argentine Mar del Plata Canyon exped / Yujin Pu, Yang Zhou, Jun Liu, Haibin Zhang · CC BY 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Deep_sea_hydrothermal_sea_vent_cucumber_Chiridota_heheva.jpg

30 OCT 2026

Scientists have discovered that three bizarre deep-sea fish that look exactly like seahorses actually belong to a separate evolutionary group, proving that nature created the same unusual body shape more than once. Nicknamed "sea muppets," these elusive creatures are known from just seven specimens, and no one has ever seen one alive.

Stone and water shaped early human movement through Arabia's deserts



A desert camp in the Rub' al Khali region of Abu Dhabi. Context photograph; not an image from the geoarchaeological survey transect described in the linked paper. / Cheezgraterz · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Rub%27_Al_Khali_Desert.jpg

28 OCT 2026

An open-access Nature paper reports that water alone may not explain where early people moved through the Rub' al Khali. An approximately 1,500-kilometre geoarchaeological survey found ancient lake evidence at some locations but no stone tools or workable tool-making stone along the surveyed transect. The authors argue that access to both freshwater and suitable stone influenced where people could settle or travel. The research offers a more layered account of past environments: a landscape can hold water and appear habitable, yet still lack a resource essential to daily life. It connects geology, ecology and human history through the practical limits imposed by a desert environment.

Landscape fragmentation threatens connectivity for sloth bears in India's Terai



An Indian sloth bear photographed in the wild. Context photograph; it is not claimed to depict one of the individual bears sampled in the Central Terai study. / Vishalsh521 · CC BY 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:An_Indian_Sloth_Bear.jpg

27 OCT 2026

A study published in Heredity examined sloth bears in India's Central Terai landscape, a human-used region where habitat fragmentation can leave animal populations isolated. Researchers used non-invasive faecal samples and genetic analysis to identify 66 individuals from 209 samples. The work focuses on how fragmented habitat can reduce connectivity and genetic exchange. The finding makes landscape connections central to conservation. Protecting a species is not only about keeping isolated patches intact; it is also about maintaining routes and habitat links that allow populations to remain connected across a changing landscape.

THE CHRONOLOGY

Signals across the window

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27 OCT 2026

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A NOTE ON THIS EDITION

A considered collection

8 stories / October 2026

This edition brings together selected ideas from the Publisher's approved records. Each story remains attributed to its originating source. The editorial layout organises the material for a calm, uninterrupted reading experience; it does not replace the original reporting or add unverified claims. Source details and credits are retained in the printed reference pages.

Living systems thrive through connection, care and time.

PROVENANCE

Sources & image credits

01 / Mongabay

Environmental defenders testify about attacks in Latin America linked to Canadian mining companies

https://news.mongabay.com/2026/10/environmental-defenders-testify-about-attacks-in-latin-america-linked-to-canadian-mining-companies/

IMAGE CREDIT: Not supplied

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02 / Phys.org - Environment

Young Canadians focus on mental health at key climate trial

https://phys.org/news/2026-10-young-canadians-focus-mental-health.html

IMAGE CREDIT: Not supplied

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03 / Mongabay

How citizen scientists are mapping Pune's trees, with hopes of a greener future

https://news.mongabay.com/2026/10/how-citizen-scientists-are-mapping-punes-trees-with-hopes-of-a-greener-future/

IMAGE CREDIT: Arup Ruidas · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:INDIAN_PITTA.jpg

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04 / Mongabay

After Botswana, Nepal tries artificial scent marking to fend big cats off villages

https://news.mongabay.com/2026/10/after-botswana-nepal-tries-artificial-scent-marking-to-fend-big-cats-off-villages/

IMAGE CREDIT: Ayush Baheti · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tiger,_India.jpg

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05 / Mongabay

Angola designates Serra do Pingano as a protected area amid rapid forest loss

https://news.mongabay.com/2026/10/angola-designates-serra-do-pingano-as-a-protected-area-amid-rapid-forest-loss/

IMAGE CREDIT: Debuapriyo · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Landscape_of_Nameri_National_Park.jpg

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06 / ScienceDaily - Environment

Scientists discover mysterious seahorse lookalikes that no one has ever seen alive

https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2026/10/261029072119.htm

IMAGE CREDIT: Yujin Pu, Yang Zhou, Jun Liu, Haibin Zhang · CC BY 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Deep_sea_hydrothermal_sea_vent_cucumber_Chiridota_heheva.jpg

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07 / Nature

Stone and water shaped early human movement through Arabia's deserts

https://www.nature.com/articles/s41586-026-11180-5

IMAGE CREDIT: Cheezgraterz · CC BY-SA 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Rub%27_Al_Khali_Desert.jpg

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08 / Heredity / Nature Portfolio

Landscape fragmentation threatens connectivity for sloth bears in India's Terai

https://www.nature.com/articles/s41437-026-00897-8

IMAGE CREDIT: Vishalsh521 · CC BY 4.0 · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:An_Indian_Sloth_Bear.jpg

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UNTIL NEXT TIME

Make room for what matters.

A thoughtful life is not assembled all at once. It grows through attention, care and the small choices we make every day.